Economic importance of the family solanaceae				
S.No.	**Economic importance**	**Binomial**	**Useful part**	**Uses**
2.	Medicinal plant	*Atropa belladonna* (deadly nightshade)	Roots	A powerful alkaloid 'atropine' obtained from root is used in belladonna plasters, tinctures etc. for relieving pain and also for dialating pupils of eyes for eye –testing.
		Datura stramonium (ஊமத்தை)	Leaves and roots	Stramonium drug obtained from the leaves and roots of this is used to treat asthma and whooping cough.
		Solanum trilobatum (தூதுவளை)	Leaves, flowers and berries	Used to treat cough.
		Withania somnifera (Ashwagandha / அமுக்காரா)	Roots	Used in curing cough and rheumatism.
3.	Tobacco	*Nicotiana tabaccum* (tobacco / புகையிலை)	Leaves are dried and made into tobacco.	Used in cigarette, beedi, hukkah, pipes as well as for chewing and snuffing, alkaloids like nicotine, nornicotine and anabasin are present in tobacco.
4.	Ornamental plants	*Cestrum diurnum* (Day Jasmine) *Cestrum nocturnum* (Night Jasmine) *Nicotiana alata Petunia hybrida*, *Schizanthus pinnatus*	Plant	Grown in garden as ornamental plants for their aesthetic nature.

Do tomatoes come from a tree?



Solanum betaceum
(Tree tomato)

5.13.4 Family: Euphorbiaceae (Castor Family / Spurge Family)



(In APG classification Peraceae, Phyllanthaceae and Picrodendraceae are excluded from the family Euphorbiaceae)

Systematic position

APG Classification		Bentham and Hooker Classification	
Kingdom	Plantae	Kingdom	Plantae
Clade:	Angiosperms	Class:	Dicotyledonae
Clade:	Eudicots	Sub-class:	Monochlamydeae
Clade:	Rosids	Series:	Unisexuales
Order:	Malpighiales	Order:	Euphorbiales
Family:	Euphorbiaceae	Family:	Euphorbiaceae

General characters

Distribution: Euphorbiaceae includes 214 genera and about 5600 species. The plants of this family are found throughout the world. Well represented in Africa and South America.

Habit: Herbs (*Phyllanthus amarus*), mostly shrubs (*Ricinus communics, Jatropha gossypifolia*) or tree (*Emblica officinalis*),

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